

Chapter 171-3

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After Liang Shi and Yang Shuyan finished recording, they flew back to Haizhou City together.

Liang Shi had told Xu Qingzhu in advance, but Xu Qingzhu had a very important meeting and said she would send her assistant to pick her up. Liang Shi immediately refused. "I can just take a taxi back myself. Besides, I can have Dr. Zhao pick me up—I haven't seen her in a while."

Xu Qingzhu chuckled softly. "You two are really like two peas in a pod now."

Liang Shi: ".....Maybe we're friends forged through adversity?"

Xu Qingzhu didn't say anything more and went straight to work.

Liang Shi just told her to take care of her health.

But unexpectedly, before boarding the plane, Liang Shi received a message from Zhao Ying: [Where are you?]

Liang Shi sent her location. Zhao Ying sent her an OK gesture: [Wait there after you get off the plane. I'll come pick you up.]

Liang Shi: [Huh?]

Zhao Ying: [The director of Mo Mo Mo Mo wants to meet you. Let's meet together.]

Liang Shi agreed: [Okay.]

After the plane landed in Haizhou, Liang Shi and Yang Shuyan got off together. Both of them were stunningly beautiful, drawing people's attention all along the way.

Especially Yang Shuyan—she had that appeal to the general public.

But Yang Shuyan's manager and assistant were both quite capable and protected her well.

Liang Shi asked Yang Shuyan where she was going next. Yang Shuyan said expressionlessly, "Home to sleep."

Her manager said helplessly, "You have to meet a director tonight."

Yang Shuyan: "That's tonight's business."

Manager: "....."

Liang Shi bid her farewell, saying they'd see each other next time.

Yang Shuyan took off her sunglasses and asked her, "How are you getting back?"

"Sister Ying is picking me up," Liang Shi said. "I have something to do later."

Yang Shuyan's expression shifted slightly. "She's coming to pick you up?"

Liang Shi nodded. "Mm, she should be arriving soon."

Yang Shuyan: "....."

She put her sunglasses back on but didn't leave.

Before long, Zhao Ying's voice came through: "Xiao Liang."

Liang Shi and Yang Shuyan turned their heads at the same time. Liang Shi pulled her suitcase forward to greet Zhao Ying. "Sister Ying."

"Why are you here too?" Zhao Ying looked surprised at the person behind her, then immediately frowned. "Stay away from my car."

Yang Shuyan: "What should be photographed has been photographed, and what shouldn't be photographed has also been photographed. What are you afraid of?"

Zhao Ying rolled her eyes. "Are you trying to ruin your career?"

Yang Shuyan: "A little scandal won't go that far."

Zhao Ying: "You're still not allowed in my car. I'm not here to pick you up."

Yang Shuyan: "Can't you just give me a ride?"

Zhao Ying: "No."

It was midday, and the sun was scorching. Haizhou was about to enter spring.

The two of them stood there bickering with expressionless faces. Liang Shi was caught in the middle. With a casual glance, she spotted a camera not far away and couldn't help but say, "Sister Ying, Sister Yan, there are paparazzi."

"Isn't that normal?" Zhao Ying shrugged. "Her schedule today is semi-public."

Yang Shuyan frowned. "I'll have someone handle it."

"If you keep dawdling here, they'll have the news article written already. What's the point of handling it then?" Zhao Ying said. "Just stay away from my car."

Yang Shuyan glanced at her, then walked straight to the car and got in.

Zhao Ying & Liang Shi: "....."

Yang Shuyan sat in the back row. Zhao Ying sat in the middle row. After Liang Shi got in, she could only sit in the back row, but Yang Shuyan's expression was too icy.

Liang Shi pressed her brow, cleared her throat softly, then leaned toward Zhao Ying and whispered, "Sister Ying, Sister Yan has something to say to you."

Zhao Ying turned around to look, and her gaze met Yang Shuyan's directly.

"What can't be said out loud?" Zhao Ying asked. "So sneaky."

"Are you sure you want me to say it out loud?" Yang Shuyan looked at her with her arms crossed, her expression cold. "I'm afraid you won't be able to handle it."

Zhao Ying: "....."

Yang Shuyan's eyes were clearly saying—if you don't come over here, I'm going to die of anger.

Zhao Ying didn't want to put Liang Shi in a difficult position, so she simply got up and went to the back row. But just as she stood up, the car shook slightly. Zhao Ying lost her balance and fell toward Yang Shuyan, landing right in her arms.

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Liang Shi caught a glimpse from the corner of her eye and immediately turned around to cover her eyes. "I didn't see anything."

The atmosphere became awkward for a moment.

Zhao Ying frowned. "Let go."

Yang Shuyan held onto her and didn't let go. "I didn't expect that after just a few days apart, you'd be this eager."

Zhao Ying gritted her teeth. "Let go."

"You're the one who came to me." Yang Shuyan's face remained expressionless, but her tone was much more relaxed than before, carrying a hint of teasing. "What are you doing later?"

"Meeting a director," Zhao Ying said. "We have a dinner appointment. Weren't you going home to sleep?"

Yang Shuyan: "I'll wait for you so we can go together."

Zhao Ying: "?"

Zhao Ying thought this person had gone crazy. But sitting on her lap was indeed more comfortable than sitting on the car seat, and she couldn't break free anyway, so she couldn't be bothered to struggle anymore.

Liang Shi messaged Xu Qingzhu: [I've been fed dog food, QAQ]

Xu Qingzhu: [Whose?]

Liang Shi: [Sister Ying's.]

Xu Qingzhu: [...I saw the trending search.]

Liang Shi: [?]

Xu Qingzhu sent her a link. The Weibo trending topic was #Yang Shuyan Zhao Ying Airport Confrontation#.

Top celebrities were top celebrities indeed.

The photos had only been posted ten minutes ago, and they were already marked as "explosive" and sitting at number one on trending, with the heat still increasing.

The comment section had already exploded.

[Zhao Ying obviously looks so arrogant and overbearing, yuck]

[Is this what they call enemies on a narrow road? Didn't expect my sis to run into Zhao Ying right after getting off the plane. Bad luck.]

[Have the Yan-dogs¹ all gone crazy? You don't need to step on Sister Ying to promote your Water Empress.]

[Anyone can see that Sister Ying was there to pick up a friend. It's your Water Empress who insisted on coming over. Shameless.]

[.....]

"Water Empress" was the derogatory nickname for Yang Shuyan.

Because Yang Shuyan's achievements were very high but she didn't have that many works that went viral, Zhao Ying's fans called her "Water Empress."²

Meanwhile, Zhao Ying was called "Bad Luck Monster" and "Scam Dog" by Yang Shuyan's fans.

The reason was that whenever Zhao Ying was involved, Yang Shuyan's works would definitely get bad reviews. And whenever Zhao Ying had a work out, she would inevitably be compared unfavorably to Yang Shuyan.

Footnotes:

¹ **"Yan-dogs" (顏狗):** A derogatory term for Yang Shuyan's fans, combining "Yan" from her name with "dog" as an insult. Fan wars in Chinese entertainment often involve such name-calling between rival fandoms.

² **"Water Empress" (水皇):** A mocking nickname implying that Yang Shuyan's achievements or awards are "watered down" or undeserved—suggesting she won them through connections or manipulation rather than genuine talent. "Water" (水) in Chinese internet slang can mean fake, inflated, or unearned.